

US equities slip as yields rise, meta spikes on strong earnings

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The S&P 500 closed at 7,670.84, down **-0.17%**, while the Nasdaq 100 edged higher to 30,339.33 (**+0.21%**). The 10-year Treasury yield jumped to 5.26% (+0.29%), pressuring rate-sensitive sectors.

Meta Platforms surged **+3.24%** after beating Q3 expectations, offsetting weakness in Apple and Nvidia. Investors watch upcoming earnings from major banks and the Fed's policy outlook.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,670.84	-0.17%	
Dow Jones	51,349.92	-0.26%	
Nasdaq 100	30,339.33	+0.21%	
Russell 2000	2,807.92	-0.35%	
VIX	16.04	-0.19%	
10Y Yield	5.26%	+0.29%	
WTI Crude	89.37	-0.01%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
META	738.79	+3.24%
AVGO	355.10	+1.58%
XLU	39.71	+1.17%
AAPL	329.40	-2.66%
NVDA	227.21	-0.72%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	Meta Platforms (META)
Revenue	38.1 bn (+12% YoY)
Earnings per share	9.84 vs. 8.12 est.
Guidance	Q4 revenue 38.5 - 39.0 bn, EPS 10.2-10.5

Meta beat both top-line and bottom-line expectations, driven by stronger ad spend in Asia-Pacific. The upbeat guidance lifted sentiment in the communication sector, offsetting broader market weakness.

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year yield: 5.26% (+0.29%)
- Today's releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PCE 04:30, Fed minutes 06:00

Geopolitics & global

- China's manufacturing PMI slipped to 48.9, raising concerns on demand rebound.
- Eurozone inflation eased to 2.3% YoY, supporting ECB's dovish stance.
- Middle-East tensions remain low; oil inventories stable, limiting upside for XLE.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30 Sep 30	JPM	Loan growth & credit quality
10:00 Sep 30	GS	Investment-banking fees amid market volatility
11:30 Sep 30	TSLA	Model Y deliveries and margin trends
13:00 Sep 30	MSFT	AI services revenue trajectory

Stocks worth watching

- **AMZN** – modest upside after beat; cloud growth accelerating.
- **XLF** – banking earnings could reverse recent dip.
- **XLE** – oil price stability may support energy stocks.
- **NVDA** – recent pullback offers entry ahead of AI demand.
- **XLU** – utility sector outperforms on higher yields.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in CPI (>0.3% MoM) could prompt another rate hike.
- Weak banking earnings, especially JPM, could spark sector sell-off.
- Escalation in Middle-East tensions pushing oil above 95.

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Meta's guidance beating expectations, lifting tech sentiment.
- Continued strength in utilities (XLU) as yields stabilize.
- Positive Eurozone data supporting risk-on flows.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — S&P 500

SEC — Meta Earnings Release

Federal Reserve — Minutes

Trading Economics — Macro Data